

Ἀρίσταρχος ὁ Σάμιος

Aristarchus of Samos on the Sizes of the Sun and Moon

eul_aid: hzi

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἰωνική [Ionic](#)

Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)

Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Aristarchus of Samos was an ancient Greek astronomer and mathematician who flourished around 280 BCE. He was a student of Strato of Lampsacus, connecting him to the Lyceum and the early Hellenistic scientific tradition. Beyond this association, few biographical details survive.

Only one of his works survives complete: *On the Sizes and Distances of the Sun and Moon*, a geometrical treatise calculating celestial distances from lunar phases. He is most famous for his heliocentric hypothesis, which placed the Sun at the center of the cosmos with a revolving Earth. This revolutionary model is not preserved in his own writings but is reported by later authors like Archimedes and Plutarch.

Aristarchus holds a pivotal place in the history of astronomy for this early heliocentric theory, a radical departure from dominant geocentric models. Though not accepted in antiquity, it was a profound conceptual leap. His surviving work exemplifies the application of rigorous geometry to astronomy, establishing a foundational methodology for later Greek science.

Works (1)

- [Περὶ Μεγεθῶν καὶ Ἀποστάσεων Ἥλιου καὶ Σελήνης](#) · [On the Sizes and Distances of the Sun and Moon](#) · 24 passages